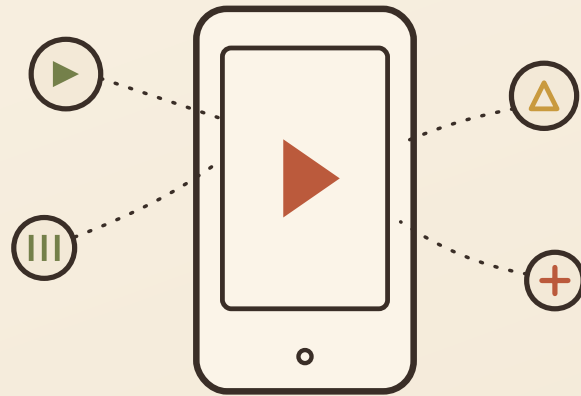


THE 0 TO 100 SERIES • PAID GUIDE

Content Creation

*From zero audience to a working content operation
that earns — one platform, one format, \$0 budget.*



0 TO 100 • CONTENT CREATION EDITION

Ten Stages, Zero Fluff

PHASE 1 • FOUNDATION (0→50)

	Stage 1: Pick your platform and format	0-10
	Stage 2: Niche and positioning	10-20
	Stage 3: The content engine	20-30
	Stage 4: Publishing cadence	30-40
	Stage 5: Analytics and iteration	40-50

PHASE 2 • SCALE (50→100)

	Stage 6: Growth systems and repurposing	50-60
	Stage 7: Community and engagement loops	60-70
	Stage 8: Monetization	70-80
	Stage 9: Building an email list	80-90
	Stage 10: Systemizing with AI tools and templates	90-100

Read This First

You're holding a roadmap, not a motivational speech.

This guide takes you from zero — no audience, no equipment, no budget — to a working content operation that earns money. Everything here uses free tools. Every stage ends with an action step.

Do the steps in order and don't skip ahead: the people who fail at content creation almost always fail because they tried to do Stage 8 before Stage 3.

One rule before you start: you are not allowed to buy anything until you've earned your first \$100 from content. Constraints force skill.



Pick your platform and format

The biggest beginner trap is trying to be everywhere. You will pick **one platform** and **one format** and stay there for at least 90 days. Repurposing comes later (Stage 6) — earning the right to repurpose comes first.

PLATFORM	BEST FORMAT	BEST IF YOU...	SPEED
TikTok/Reels/Shorts	Short vertical video	Can talk to camera	Fast reach
YouTube (long)	8-15 min video	Explain in depth	Slow, best long-term
X (Twitter)	Threads + posts	Write well, hooks	Fast in biz/tech
LinkedIn	Text + carousels	Pro experience	Best for B2B
Instagram	Carousels + Reels	Visual niche	Medium
Blog/Newsletter	Written articles	Love writing	Slow, you own it

✦ **Decision shortcut:** if you're unsure, pick short vertical video (TikTok + auto-crosspost to Reels/Shorts later). It has the fastest feedback loop — you'll learn in 30 days what would take a blogger a year to learn.

Free tools: CapCut (editing, auto-captions), Canva (carousels, thumbnails), OBS Studio (screen recording), your phone camera, Audacity (audio cleanup).

ACTION STEPS

1. Write one sentence: "For the next 90 days I will post [format] on [platform]." Install the tools for that format today.



Niche and positioning

"Niche" doesn't mean picking a topic — it means picking a **specific person with a specific problem** and becoming the account they think of first.

1. **List 3 topics** you can talk about for 100 posts without dying of boredom. "Learning in public" requires zero expertise and is one of the strongest angles.
2. **Run each through 3 filters:** do people spend money here? Is there active demand? Can you produce here for six months?
3. **Narrow one level down.** The formula: *[topic] for [specific person] who [specific constraint or goal]*.
4. **Write your positioning line:** "I help [who] do [what] without [pain point]." This becomes your bio and your content filter.
5. **Study 5 winning accounts** in your niche and save their top 5 posts each — a 25-post swipe file of proven ideas (make your own version, don't copy).
6. **Set up your profile:** clear photo, positioning line in bio, no link yet.

⚠ If the top account in your proposed niche has under 10k followers, widen slightly — too narrow means no audience.

ACTION STEPS

1. Fill in the blank and put it in your bio today: "I help _____ do _____ without _____."



The content engine

hooks, formats, batching

Consistency doesn't come from motivation. It comes from a system that makes creating content mechanical — three parts.

Part 1 • Hooks

HOOK TYPE	TEMPLATE
Negative/warning	"Stop doing X"
Curiosity gap	"The X nobody talks about"
Specific result	"How I got X in Y days"
Mistake	"I wasted X so you don't have to"
Contrarian	"X is a lie / you don't need X"
List	"N things/tools/mistakes for X"

Part 2 • Formats

Pick 3 repeatable formats and rotate them: a quick tip, a "watch me do X" process video, a reaction/breakdown. Repeatable formats kill the "what do I post today?" problem.

Part 3 • Batching

1. **Idea day** (30 min/wk): generate 10–15 ideas from your swipe file, competitor comments, ChatGPT.
2. **Script day** (60 min/wk): hook (1 line) → payoff (3–5 lines) → CTA (1 line). Under 100 words.
3. **Record day** (60–90 min/wk): film everything in one session, same setup.
4. **Edit day** (60–90 min/wk): auto-captions, cut dead air, trending audio low.

✧ That's 4–5 hours a week producing 5–7 posts. Track everything in Notion or Sheets: Idea → Hook → Status → Post date → Views.



STAGE 4 • 30-40

Publishing cadence

and your first 100 posts

Here's the truth nobody sells you: **your first 100 posts are practice**. All of them are tuition, and unlike a course, this tuition is free and pays you back in data.

1. **Set your cadence, non-negotiable:** short video 1/day (min 5/wk); text 1-2/day; long YouTube 1-2/wk; blog 1-2/wk.
2. **Post at consistent times** — consistency matters more than "optimal hours."
3. **Front-load a buffer** of 5-7 finished posts before publishing post #1.
4. **Use free schedulers:** Meta Business Suite, TikTok's native scheduler, Buffer free plan.
5. **Engage for 15 minutes after posting** — reply to every comment, leave 5-10 genuine comments elsewhere.
6. **Track every post:** views at 24h/7d, likes, comments, follows gained.
7. **Do not delete flops** — old posts resurface, and flop data is instructive too.

~20

WANT TO QUIT

~50

NOTICEABLY FASTER

100

REAL DATA + SKILL

ACTION STEPS

1. Bank 5 finished posts, then publish post #1 today. Write "1/100" somewhere visible and count up.



Analytics and iteration

Posting without reviewing data is throwing darts blindfolded. From post ~20 onward, run a simple weekly review.

SYMPTOM	FIX
Nobody sees it (low reach)	Hook or topic problem — test proven hook formats
They see it, don't watch (low retention)	First 3 seconds too slow — cut the intro
They watch, don't act (low likes/comments)	No emotion or CTA — add a question
They engage, no follower growth	Profile problem — unclear bio or niche

✦ **Apply the 80/20 rule:** next week, make 80% of your content variations of what already worked and 20% new experiments. If one post massively outperforms, make a part 2 within 48 hours.

⚠ **Change one variable per experiment or you learn nothing.** Check stats weekly, not hourly — hourly checking is emotionally exhausting and statistically meaningless.

II

Scale

STAGES 6-10 · 50 → 100

You now have a working engine: one platform, a defined audience, proven formats, and a weekly feedback loop. Phase 2 multiplies output and turns attention into income.



Growth systems and repurposing

You earned the right to expand. The rule: **create once, publish everywhere — without multiplying your workload.** Your home platform stays primary; everything else is derivative.

1. **Map your repurposing chain:** short video → native uploads to TikTok, Reels, *and* YouTube Shorts separately; video script → X/Threads/LinkedIn post; top 3 tips → Canva carousel; long video → 3-5 shorts.
2. **Sequence, don't parallelize.** Add ONE secondary platform per month.
3. **Add 30 minutes to edit day** for repurposing — no new record days.
4. **Batch-schedule** secondary platforms with free tools so they run on autopilot.
5. **Adapt the packaging, not the substance** — same idea, different hook style per platform.

⚠ Auto-crossposting with watermarks gets suppressed by Instagram and YouTube. Re-export clean, native uploads only.



Community and engagement loops

Followers are a number. A community is an asset. The difference is whether people *interact* — and interaction is engineered, not hoped for.

1. **Reply to every comment** for your first year. Non-negotiable.
2. **Build engagement loops into content:** end with a specific, low-effort question; run polls; make "you asked, I answered" content.
3. **Create recurring rituals** — a named weekly series gives people a reason to come back.
4. **Use DMs deliberately** — thank thoughtful commenters, no pitch, just human.
5. **Spend 15 min/day** being a community member, not just a broadcaster.
6. **Start a gathering point** (Discord/broadcast channel) once you pass ~1,000 engaged followers.

✧ The 20 people who comment on everything are your street team and first buyers. Learn their names.



Monetization

digital products, affiliate, sponsorships, UGC

You don't need 100k followers to earn. You need 1,000 people who trust you and one clear offer.

STREAM	FOLLOWERS NEEDED	INCOME (EARLY)
Affiliate marketing	~500+	\$50-500/mo
Digital products	~1,000 engaged	\$100-2,000/mo
UGC	0 — brands buy content	\$100-1,500/mo
Sponsorships	~5,000-10,000	\$50-500/post

1. **Start with affiliate (month 4+).** Recommend tools you genuinely use. Always disclose.
2. **Build your first digital product (months 5-6):** package your most-asked question as a PDF or template. Price \$5-19.
3. **Validate before you build.** Post: "I'm putting together a guide on X — who'd want it?" Fewer than 10 responses = pick a different topic.
4. **Add UGC** if you want income without an audience — brands pay for the content skill itself, \$50-150/video as a beginner.
5. **Take sponsorships selectively (5k+ followers).** Floor of \$10-25 per 1,000 followers per post.

⚠ Monetizing at 50 followers wastes the pitch. Build trust first — and never promote products you've never used.



Building an email list

Every platform can throttle your reach, suspend your account, or die. Your email list is the only audience you *own*.

1. **Pick a free platform:** MailerLite (free to 1,000), Kit (free to 10,000), or Beehiiv (free to 2,500).
2. **Create a lead magnet:** a checklist, Notion template, swipe file, or 5-email mini-course — solves one problem in under 10 minutes.
3. **Set up the pipeline:** landing page → link in bio → automated welcome email.
4. **Write a 3-email welcome sequence:** deliver freebie + story → best advice, no pitch → soft mention of paid product.
5. **Promote the magnet** in content once or twice a week.
6. **Email your list weekly.** Every fourth email or so can sell.

30-50%

OPEN RATES

\$1

PER SUBSCRIBER/MO

500

CAN OUT-EARN 20K FOLLOWERS



A cold list is a dead list. Never buy email lists or add people without consent — it kills deliverability and is illegal in most jurisdictions.



Systemizing with AI tools and templates

Done manually, running everything is 20+ hours a week. Systemized, it's under 10.

1. **Template everything you do more than twice:** script templates, editing presets, Canva Brand Kit, email templates.
2. **Use AI at the right points:** ideation (new hooks from your best-performing ones), repurposing (script → LinkedIn post/thread), comments-to-content (top 5 recurring questions → next topics).
3. **Never let AI replace your voice.** AI produces the first 70%, your judgment and stories produce the 30% that makes it yours.
4. **Build a one-page operating system** in Notion: weekly schedule, content tracker, template library, metrics dashboard.
5. **Run a monthly CEO hour:** review income by stream, growth by platform, what to cut, what to double.

⚠ Publishing raw AI output reads generic, performs badly, and erodes the trust you spent nine stages building.

THIS WEEK

1. Turn your single best-performing post into three templates: its script structure, its edit style, and its repurposed text version.

Where You Are Now

If you've worked through all ten stages, look at what exists that didn't before: a focused account, a niche and positioning line that filter every decision, a content engine producing 5–7 posts a week, 100+ published posts, a weekly analytics loop, content flowing across platforms, a community that talks back, at least one income stream, an email list you own outright, and a system that runs it all in under 10 hours a week.

That's not "trying content creation." That's a small media business, built for \$0.

The 0 to 100 Series

Selling PDFs · Web Dev with AI · Affiliate Marketing · Earning Money with AI